

PURPOSE

To help hitters hit the ball with a level swing, and avoid looping or uppercutting.

SET UP

- Set up two batting tees at the plate as shown in the illustration.
- One directly over the plate. One directly in front of it.
- Both tees should be set to the same height.
- The batter sets up in her normal stance.

**INSTRUCTIONS**

1. Place one ball on each tee.
2. The hitter will check her alignment by taking a slow practice swing – making sure that the sweet spot lines up with the ball.
3. On the coach's signal, the hitter makes her stride, then a full swing, trying to make line drive contact with the first ball.
4. If done correctly the first ball will ricochet directly into the second ball, indicating a level swing and line drive contact.

COACHING TIPS

- Reaching for the ball or uppercutting will pop the first ball up over the second. Swinging on an overly steep downward plane will drive the first ball into the ground.
- To make this more challenging, try this drill using the top hand or bottom hand only. Choke up or use a lighter bat to maintain control.

- **Make it easier:** Start with one tee facing a fence, net or backstop. Identify a line drive target for the hitter to aim for.
- **Make it harder:** Add a third tee and ball. Can the hitter create a three-ball chain reaction?